

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 873

By Darby

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Weakley County
Sheriff's Deputy Derrick R. Bonham.

WHEREAS, our nation was conceived by individuals who were willing to sacrifice their own concerns to ensure our collective freedom and personal safety; in providing for the domestic tranquility of the community as a whole, society recognizes the need for a system of laws; and

WHEREAS, the enforcement of the law has been entrusted to a small number of dedicated individuals who face daily the rigors of human conflict in protecting those whom they so selflessly serve; and

WHEREAS, the people of Tennessee are fortunate to be served by the brave and dedicated law enforcement officers who put their lives on the line while carrying out their essential duties; and

WHEREAS, Deputy Derrick R. Bonham of the Weakley County Sheriff's Department was one such outstanding and heroic public servant, who gave his life while serving his fellow citizens on January 30, 2026; and

WHEREAS, born on December 6, 1988, Deputy Bonham was a resident of Greenfield; a veteran of the United States Army, he graduated from the Tennessee Law Enforcement Training Academy on December 21, 2023, and honorably served the citizens of Weakley County with the Sheriff's Office for nearly two years; and

WHEREAS, Deputy Bonham chose a life of service in every capacity—a life rooted in protecting and serving everyone in his community, standing strong in the face of uncertainty and danger, and answering the call when his community needed him; and

WHEREAS, his courage, humility, quiet strength, kindness, and commitment to duty reflect the very best of humanity; and

WHEREAS, Deputy Derrick Bonham was deeply devoted to his family and always endeavored to remain true to family values of the highest order; and

WHEREAS, left to mourn his memory and carry on his legacy are his wife, Nicole Bonham; children, Harper, Hayden, and Hudson; mother, Bertha Bonham; father, John Bonham; brother, "John Boy" (Cynthia) Bonham; nephew and niece, Daniel and Frankie; in-laws, Troy and BeLynda Jones; uncle, Jerry Armes; and grandmother-in-law, June Neblett; and

WHEREAS, Deputy Bonham leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity, probity, and valor in his public life as a law enforcement officer, compassion and loyalty in private life, and dedication in all his chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we should remember the too brief yet bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor the life of Weakley County Sheriff's Deputy Derrick R. Bonham, reflecting fondly upon his character and his commitment to public service.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family and friends of Deputy Bonham.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.